to lead his country to socialism, previously ignored, had finally paid off, but only after his unexpected attack on Moscow's allies in Havana. Khrushchev's hitherto cautious approach to Castro and Cuba was completely abandoned on April 18, when he sent a letter to "Comrade Fidel Castro" commemorating the first anniversary of the Cuban victory at the Bay of Pigs. Castro had finally gotten Khrushchev on an ideological leash, but Khrushchev was willing to be caught. His motive was not purely ideological. Great-power rivalry and the nuclear arms race with the United States, which Khrushchev knew he was losing, were among the factors that attracted him to Cuba.[21]